

JUST LOVING IT

NAMITA THAPAR SIMPLY loves her business. As Executive Director of the India business at Pune-based Emcure Pharmaceuticals, she barely pauses when you ask her what the vision for the company is. "We will continue to scale both our domestic and international businesses and sustain our investments in R&D, especially novelty drug delivery systems, complex injectables & biosimilars, apart from strengthening our manufacturing capabilities," she says.

A prominent face for a while, following the success of *Shark Tank India*, Thapar comes with strong academic credentials. She qualified as a chartered accountant at just 21, before going on to Duke Uni-

versity's Fuqua School of Business for an MBA. The next six years were spent working for cardiovascular device manufacturer Guidant Corporation across finance and marketing. In 2007, she came back and took charge as CFO of Emcure, founded by her father Satish Mehta, which is primarily into manufacturing formulations and APIs. At that point, it was a ₹500 crore company; today it is at well over ₹6,000 crore.

As business grew, so did her responsibilities. "The way to handle that is to hire people way smarter than me and empowering them. It also helps that I am very good at time management," she says. **BT**

— **BY KRISHNA GOPALAN**

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

I love what I do. It's intellectually stimulating and also nourishes my soul when I see the social impact of our work

A LIFE LESSON LEARNT ON THE JOB

Less is more



NAMITA THAPAR
46, EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR,
EMCURE PHARMACEUTICALS



NANDINI PIRAMAL
43, CHAIRPERSON, PIRAMAL PHARMA LIMITED

Stable Hand

FOR NANDINI PIRAMAL, Chairperson of Piramal Pharma Limited (PPL), profitable business growth is synonymous with responsibility and sustainability. After a challenging FY23, the current fiscal is about recovery and turnaround for the business. The pharma company's revenue from operations in Q2FY24 grew by 11 per cent year-on-year to ₹1,911 crore. This turnaround was possible thanks to Piramal's focus on organic growth, cost control and operational excellence.

Under Piramal's leadership, PPL journeyed towards sustainable growth and expansion at a steady pace. In August 2023, PPL closed a rights issue and paid off ₹950 crore in debt. Today, PPL has 17 manu-

facturing sites worldwide and a global distribution network spread over 100 countries.

For Piramal, sustainability targets are equally important. And with over 40 per cent of corporate roles in the organisation being occupied by women, she has ensured that diversity and inclusion are key focus areas. PPL is finalising plans for \$40 million (around ₹330 crore) in capex in H2FY24. The launch of 26 products in FY23, growth of e-commerce by more than 40 per cent and a target to touch ₹1,000 crore from the OTC business this year reinforces PPL's objective of consistent sustainable growth. **BT**

— **BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

WHY SHE MATTERS

She led her company to significant financial achievements. Despite challenges, her strategic focus on organic growth and operational excellence led to 14 per cent revenue growth in H1FY24